



Gabbard resigns Cabinet position

Husband's rare bone cancer battle cited in leaving job June 30

By Meg Kinnard, Will Weissert and David Klepper
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Tulsi Gabbard resigned as President Donald Trump's director of national intelligence on Friday, saying she needed to leave office as her husband battles cancer, becoming the fourth Cabinet member to depart during Trump's second term.

In her resignation letter, which she posted on social media, Gabbard said she told Trump she would leave her job overseeing the coordination of 18 intelligence agencies on June 30. She said her husband had recently been diagnosed with a rare form of bone cancer and "faces major challenges in the coming weeks and months."

"At this time, I must step away from public service to be by his side and fully support him through this battle," she wrote in the letter, which was reported earlier by Fox News.

Trump, in his own social media post, said, "Tulsi has done an incredible job, and we will miss her." He said her principal deputy, Aaron Lukas, will serve as acting director of national intelligence.

While Gabbard says her departure is for personal reasons, the juxtaposition between her long-held, anti-interventionism stance and Trump's series of overseas military operations had seemed to put them on a collision course.

There had been rumblings that Gabbard would split with Trump after the president's decision to strike Iran, which caused some division within his administration. Joe Kent, director of the National



Gabbard



Widow Colleen Decker holds a Chicago flag following the funeral services for husband, Chicago firefighter Steven Decker, at St. Paul Lutheran Church in Chicago on Friday. Decker's son Matt is at left and mother Geraldine is at right. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

'A devastating loss'

Hundreds attend funeral services for Chicago firefighter Steven Decker

By Allison Kiehl | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Bells tolled and bagpipes played a somber rendition of "Amazing Grace" Friday morning outside St. Paul Lutheran Church on the city's Northwest Side. Service members held a crisp white-gloved salute for Chicago firefighter Steven Decker, a 30-year veteran who died during a training exercise on the city's Far North Side last week.

Hundreds of firefighters and community members alike gathered at the church where Decker was confirmed into the Christian faith nearly 50 years ago. Each pew was full, and a small crowd gathered in the room beyond.

The service was a traditional Lutheran burial service with scripture readings, eulogies from loved ones and hymns.

"Having that many first responders in church was fantastic," said the Rev. Todd Roberts, pastor of St. Paul Lutheran Church. "First responders are the most wonderful, giving people in the world



Chicago Fire Department engineer Steven Decker, a 30-year veteran, suffered a medical emergency May 14 during an equipment test. **CHICAGO FIRE DEPARTMENT**

because they put their life on the line every day of the week for us, to keep us safe"

Lt. Andrew Paukert started at Engine 71 on the same day as Decker. They both transferred into the unit back in 2012 and remained friends. Paukert described Decker as a father figure.

"He was one of the nicest guys you could have ever met," Paukert said. "He was a handyman, always taking charge and always making things better for everyone, whether it be firemen or people in the community."

Decker was the kind of person you could always turn to for both a good meal and needed advice.

"He always put the city first," Paukert said. "He always wanted to help. Whatever people needed, he was there to help with."

On May 14, Decker, 61, suffered a medical emergency during an annual equipment test, according to fire officials and the Cook County medical

See **DECKER** on Page A4



A pedestrian stops to read a lawn sign encouraging area residents to contact Ald. Timmy Knudsen, 43rd, about expansion plans for Francis W. Parker School Friday in Chicago. **JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Francis W. Parker plans expansion

School proposal draws support and ire from community members

By Kate Perez
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A proposal to expand the footprint of Francis W. Parker School and add athletic field lighting is generating controversy — the latest chapter in the fractious history between the private school

and its Lincoln Park neighbors.

The conflict centers around a plan to add athletic field lighting, a pedestrian overpass and a new building to Parker's campus. While the school has said the additions are needed to reach more students, some community members say the school continues to overstep, as it has for years.

Multiple organizations have taken issue with the proposal, writing letters and submitting petitions to city officials oppos-

ing it. Earlier this month, the Mid-North Association, an organization aimed at preserving the historic character of the mid-north neighborhood in Lincoln Park, penned an open letter of opposition to Ald. Timmy Knudsen, 43rd, charging that the overall development plans would diminish the neighborhood's historic character, residents, property tax base and affordable housing.

See **SCHOOL** on Page A2

KITT replica car gets New York City speeding ticket while at Volo Museum

By Joseph States
PIONEER PRESS

A replica of KITT, a car featured in "Knight Rider" — a TV series that ran from 1982-86 — that's parked and on display at the Volo Museum was hit with a \$50 speeding ticket earlier this month, and from New York City of all places.

The incident, which museum officials say has since been cleared up, drew national and then international attention, the second such occurrence in as many months. Last month, on the 114th anniversary of the Titanic's sinking, the museum's Titanic exhibit flooded after heavy storms that week.

Following the news maelstrom, the NYC Department of Transportation sent out a brief statement in response: "NYC DOT's automated speed enforcement cameras are extremely accurate, with 99.7% of all violations upheld. This violation was issued in error and will be dismissed."

Jim Wojdyla, the museum's marketing director, said it has roots going back 60 years. The Grams family, which still owns the museum, ran an antique mall that became famous for selling classic cars.

In the decades since, it's grown into an eclectic collection of historic, movie and TV cars, film props, carousels and animatronics, although buying and selling classic cars is still the "meat and potatoes" of the business, Wojdyla said.

In their collection sits a replica of KITT. "Knight Rider" starred David Hasselhoff as Michael Knight, who fought crime assisted by "Knight Industries Two Thousand," or KITT, a heavily modified Pontiac Firebird Trans Am with an artificial intelligence that could trade quips with Hasselhoff.

At the Volo Museum, KITT sits just in front of a replica of the "Back to the Future" DeLorean.

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IN SPORTS

Cubs lose 4-2 to Astros

The Cubs finished 0-for-9 with runners in scoring position, stranded 11 base runners, mustered just four hits and lost their sixth straight game to the Houston Astros on Friday afternoon. "That's frustrating," manager Craig Counsell said.

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